Lab 1: Active Directory & IAM Fundamentals

Objective

Create and manage users and groups in Active Directory, perform login testing, handle password resets, and troubleshoot common account issues.

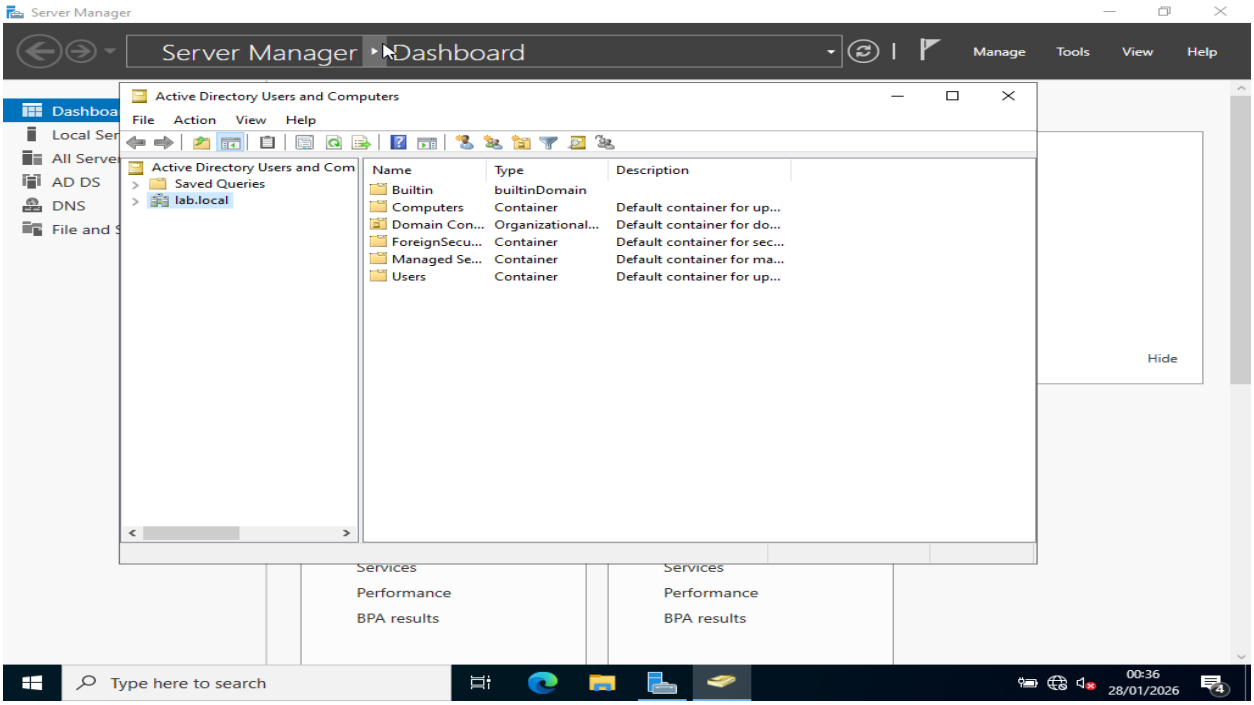
Environment

- Virtual Machine: Windows Server (AD-Server)
- VirtualBox
- Domain: LAB
- Administrator account: LAB

Step 1: Verify AD Environment

1. Open Server Manager → Tools → Active Directory Users and Computers
2. Navigate to LAB → Users
3. Confirm existing users and groups:
    - Users: jdoe, [second user]
    - Groups: LabAdmins

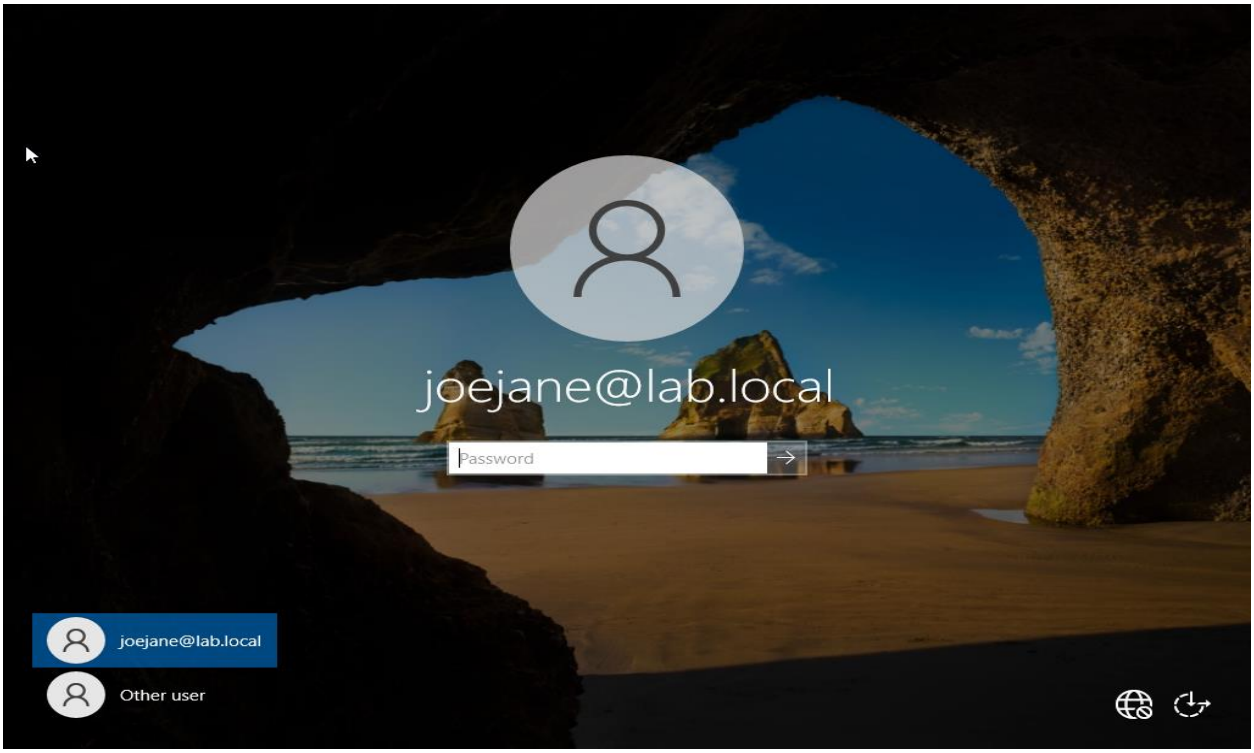
Screenshot: Lab1_AD_Users.png



Step 2: User Login Testing

1. Sign out from LAB
2. On the login screen, select Other User (or manually type the username)
3. Log in as LABwith password Pass@1234
4. Observe first login setup and desktop availability

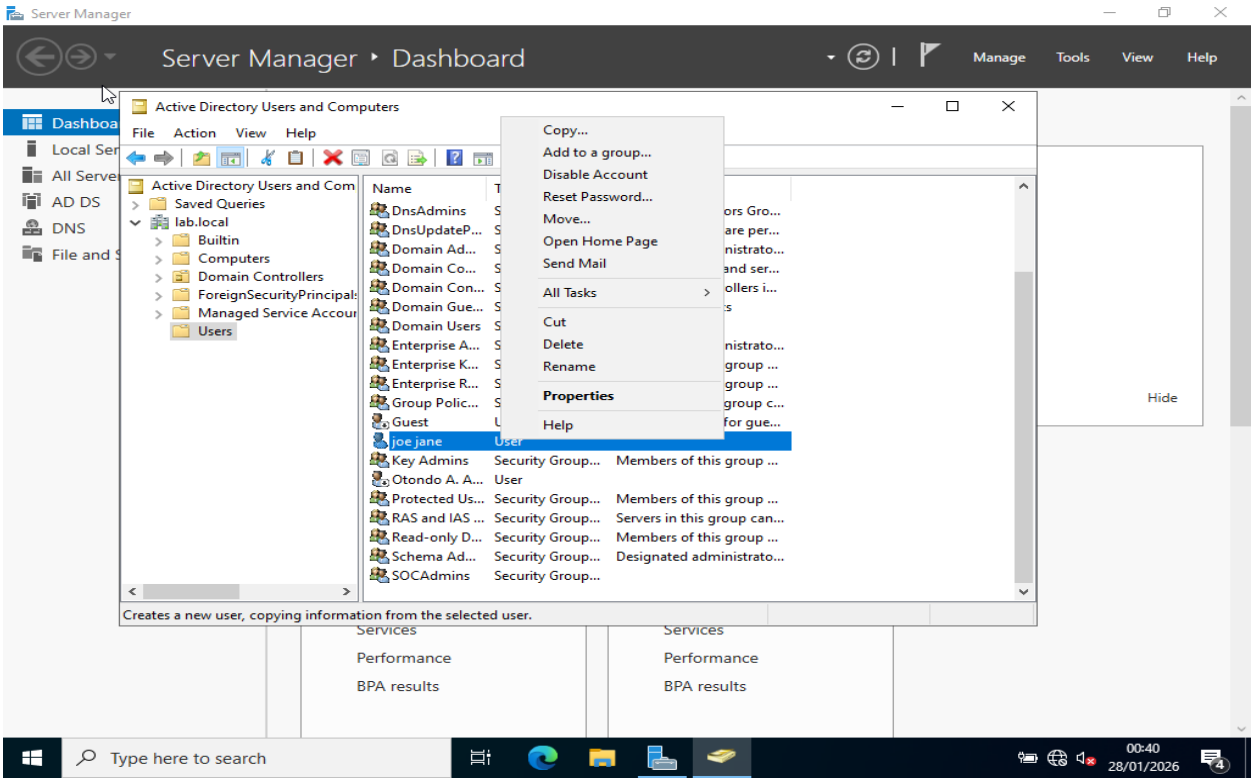
Screenshot: Lab1_UserLogin.png



Step 3: Password Reset

1. Log back in as LAB
2. Open AD Users and Computers → Users → Right-click jdoe → Reset Password
3. Set new password (TempP@ss123)
4. Optional: Check 'User must change password at next logon'

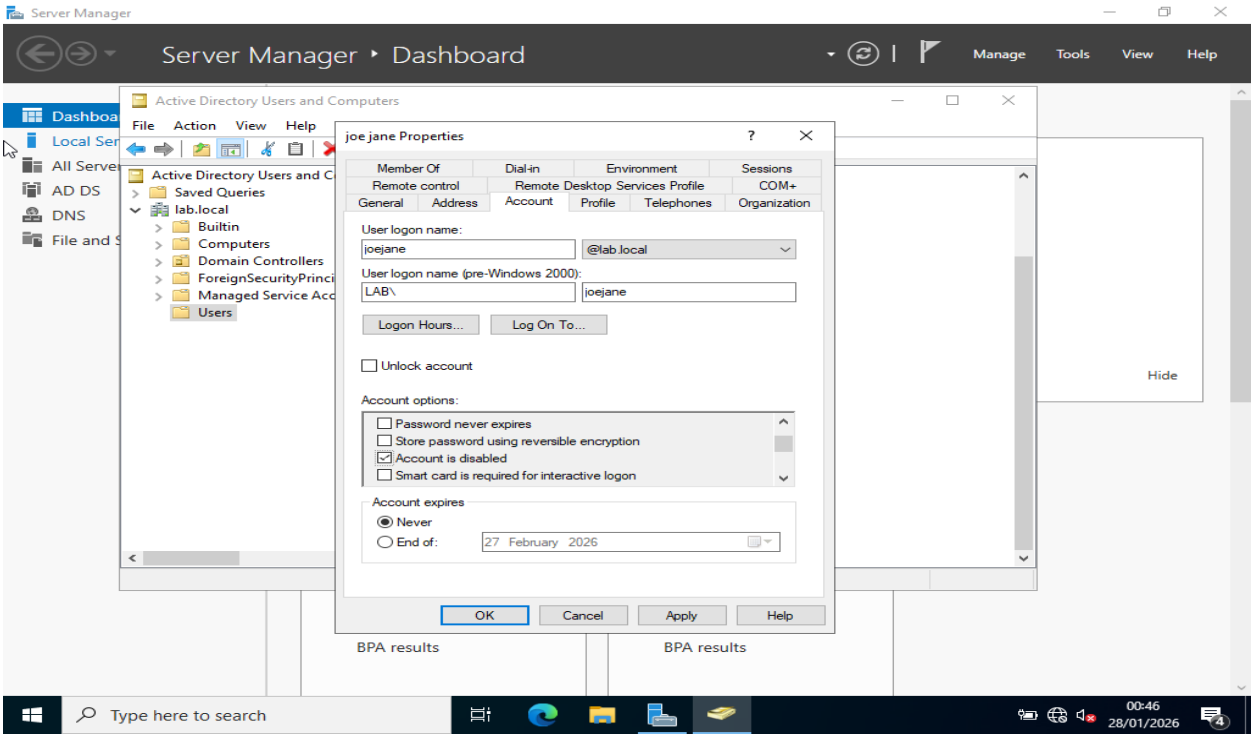
Screenshot: Lab1_PasswordReset.png



Step 4: Account Enable/Disable

1. Check if jdoe account is disabled (down arrow on icon)
2. Right-click → Enable Account if necessary
3. Ensure account is not locked out

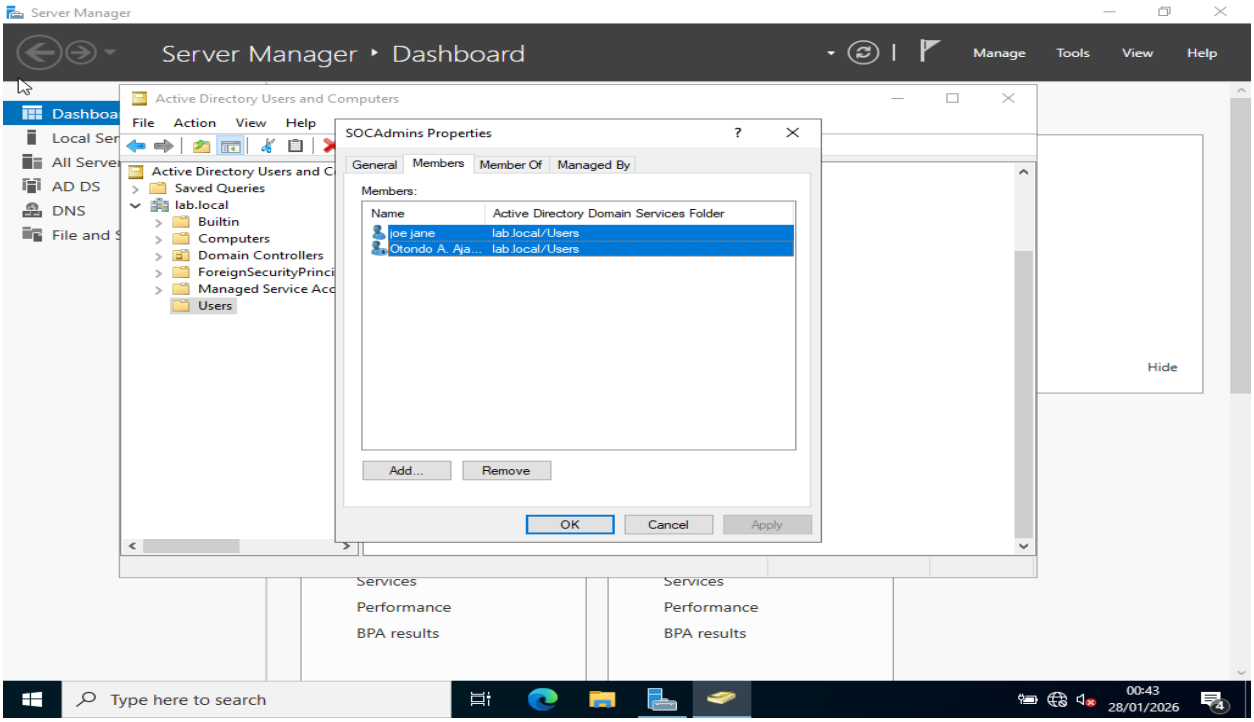
Screenshot: Lab1_AccountEnable.png



Step 5: Group Membership

1. Confirm jdoe is a member of LabAdmins
2. Add a second user to LabAdmins
3. Verify members in the group

Screenshot: Lab1_LabAdminsGroup.png



Troubleshooting Notes

- Login failure due to account disabled → resolved by enabling account
- Login failure due to password mismatch → resolved by resetting password
- VM keyboard focus required for Ctrl+Alt+Del operations

Lessons Learned

- Domain Controller login behavior differs from normal Windows PCs
- AD objects (users, groups) persist even after VM restart
- Keyboard capture issues in VirtualBox are common and expected
- Real-world IT support skills include diagnosing login and account issues

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Next Steps

- Lab 2: IT Support Ticket Scenarios
- Lab 3: Windows Server Services & Event Viewer
- Lab 4: Azure AD / Microsoft Entra Basics